

Christmas Checklist

Everything you need for a stress-free Christmas

Created by Sigil and Scribe, LLC

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Planning and Preparation



Set Your Christmas Budget

- ❑ Decide spending limits for gifts, food, travel, and décor
- ❑ Create a spreadsheet or use a budgeting app
- ❑ Include donations and holiday events

💡 *Track your totals weekly to avoid last-minute stress.*

Create Your Christmas Calendar

- ❑ Note work parties, school events, and travel dates
- ❑ Schedule decorating day and shopping deadlines
- ❑ Plan rest days to avoid burnout

💡 *Use color-coded pens or stickers for each category.*

Make Travel Plans

- ❑ Book flights, trains, or rental cars early
- ❑ Confirm accommodations (hotel, Airbnb, or family stays)
- ❑ Prepare pet care or house sitting if needed

💡 *Keep all confirmations in a digital folder for easy access.*

🌟 *The best gift you can give yourself this season is peace of mind.*

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Christmas Budget

Category/ Person	Budget	Actual	Notes

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Gifts and Shopping



Make Your Gift List

- ☐ Write down everyone you plan to buy for
- ☐ Brainstorm gift ideas for each person
- ☐ Note preferred stores or websites

💡 *Keep your list in both print and digital form for easy access.*

Set Gift Spending Limits

- ☐ Assign a budget per person
- ☐ Track costs as you buy
- ☐ Adjust totals if you find better deals

💡 *Use a simple spreadsheet or printable chart to stay on track.*

Shop for Gifts

- ☐ *Shop online early to avoid shipping delays*
- ☐ *Look for holiday sales (Black Friday, Cyber Monday)*
- ☐ *Support local or handmade businesses when possible*

💡 *Track shipping and delivery dates to avoid mix-ups.*

Wrap & Label Gifts

- ☐ *Buy wrapping paper, tape, tags, and bows*
- ☐ *Set aside a wrapping station or table*
- ☐ *Label gifts clearly (especially if traveling)*

💡 *Color-code wrapping by family or theme for easy sorting.*

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Gift Tracker

Recipient	Gift Idea	Budget	Actual Cost	Wrapped (yes/no)	Delivered (yes/no)

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Food and Cooking



Plan Christmas Meals

- ☐ *Decide on your holiday menu (breakfast, dinner, and desserts)*
- ☐ *Account for dietary restrictions or allergies*
- ☐ *Assign dishes if hosting potluck-style*

💡 *Start planning your menu at least 2-3 weeks in advance to avoid last-minute stress.*

Grocery Shopping

- ☐ *Make a detailed list for all ingredients*
- ☐ *Shop nonperishables early to beat the crowds*
- ☐ *Schedule your perishable shopping trip 2-3 days before Christmas*

💡 *Divide your list by store sections: produce, pantry, dairy, bakery, etc.*

Meal Prep & Baking

- ☐ *Bake cookies or treats early and freeze them*
- ☐ *Prepare sauces, sides, or dough in advance*
- ☐ *Set up serving dishes, utensils, and storage containers*

💡 *Label frozen items with prep dates and reheating instructions*

Beverages & Extras

- ☐ *Stock up on coffee, cocoa, wine, or cider*
- ☐ *Create a signature drink or punch*
- ☐ *Don't forget napkins, cups, and ice!*

💡 *Infuse your beverages with cinnamon sticks, orange slices, or cranberries for a festive touch.*

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Christmas Eve Dinner

Dish	Who's Cooking	Notes

Shopping List

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Christmas Breakfast

Dish	Who's Cooking	Notes

Shopping List

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Christmas Dinner

Dish	Who's Cooking	Notes

Shopping List

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Decorating and Atmosphere



Get Decorations Ready

- ☐ Pull out and test lights and ornaments
- ☐ Replace broken bulbs or garlands
- ☐ Clean and dust areas before decorating

💡 *Organize décor by room or theme before you start.*

Decorate Your Home

- ☐ Set up the Christmas tree and test the lights
- ☐ Decorate mantels, doors, and windows
- ☐ Add wreaths, candles, and seasonal scents

💡 *Balance sparkle and simplicity — focus on warmth, not clutter.*

Outdoor Décor

- ☐ Hang exterior lights safely and securely
- ☐ Add porch or yard decorations
- ☐ Check outdoor timers and replace batteries

💡 *Use weatherproof extension cords and outdoor-safe materials.*

Create Cozy Ambience

- ☐ Use candles, fairy lights, or string lights for soft glow
- ☐ Play soft Christmas music or nature-inspired sounds
- ☐ Use pine, cinnamon, or vanilla scents to fill the air

💡 *Combine lighting, sound, and scent for a true holiday atmosphere.*

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Holiday Clothing and Personal Prep



Plan Outfits

- ☐ Choose outfits for Christmas Eve, Day, and parties
- ☐ Make sure everything fits and is clean
- ☐ Buy or borrow any missing accessories or shoes

💡 *Lay out your outfits by date or event to save time later.*

Coordinate Family Looks

- ☐ Choose a color palette or theme (classic, cozy, or matching PJs!)
- ☐ Plan coordinated outfits for family photos
- ☐ Schedule a photo session or take pictures at home

💡 *Soft neutrals, plaid, or jewel tones photograph beautifully for holiday shoots.*

Grooming & Beauty Prep

- ☐ Schedule haircuts, nail appointments, or spa days early
- ☐ Choose festive makeup looks or nail colors
- ☐ Set aside time for self-care and relaxation

💡 *Book appointments 2-3 weeks ahead to secure your spot.*

Winter Wear & Essentials

- ☐ Check coats, scarves, hats, and gloves for wear
- ☐ Launder or refresh outerwear and blankets
- ☐ Keep warm layers ready for travel or outdoor events

💡 *Place a basket near the door for gloves, scarves, and hats — no more searching!*

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Appointment Tracker

Appointment	Date	Time	Location

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Cards and Communication



Update Address List

- ☐ Gather updated mailing addresses for friends and family
 - ☐ Verify email addresses for digital greetings
 - ☐ Store your list in a spreadsheet or address book
- 💡 *Keep a digital copy so you can easily update it next year!*

Choose & Design Cards

- ☐ Decide between printed, handmade, or digital cards
 - ☐ Choose a photo or design that fits your theme
 - ☐ Write a short, heartfelt message or holiday quote
- 💡 *Canva has free and premium Christmas card templates, customize and print directly!*

Write & Address Cards

- ☐ Schedule time to write a few cards per day
 - ☐ Double-check spelling of names and addresses
 - ☐ Add personal touches or handwritten notes
- 💡 *Handwriting a simple note adds warmth and sincerity, even in short messages.*

Mail or Send Greetings

- ☐ Buy stamps early or use online postage
 - ☐ Mail cards by the first week of December
 - ☐ Schedule e-cards or email newsletters for timely delivery
- 💡 *Include a family photo or update letter for an extra personal touch.*

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Acts of Kindness and Giving



Plan Your Giving

- ☐ Decide how much to set aside for donations or charitable gifts
- ☐ Choose organizations or causes that matter most to you
- ☐ Consider both local and global charities

💡 *Even a small, consistent donation can make a huge difference.*

Gift with Purpose

- ☐ Support small businesses or handmade artisans
- ☐ Give meaningful gifts like experiences or acts of service
- ☐ Wrap gifts with sustainable materials or reusable packaging

💡 *A heartfelt note or time spent together can mean more than a store-bought gift.*

Acts of Kindness

- ☐ Pay for someone's coffee or meal
- ☐ Leave kind notes for strangers
- ☐ Volunteer your time or talents locally
- ☐ Visit or call someone who may feel alone

💡 *Kindness doesn't need to cost a thing — a smile, a word, or a gesture all count.*

Giving as a Family

- ☐ Let each family member pick a cause or person to help
- ☐ Create kindness traditions (like baking for neighbors or visiting shelters)
- ☐ Discuss the meaning of generosity together

💡 *Teaching children to give builds gratitude and compassion.*

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Family and Kids Activities



Plan Family Traditions

- ☐ Write down your favorite annual traditions (decorating, baking, movie nights)
- ☐ Add one new tradition to try this year
- ☐ Involve everyone in choosing activities

💡 *Traditions don't have to be fancy — consistency makes memories special.*

Indoor Family Fun

- ☐ Christmas movie marathon or pajama day
- ☐ Bake cookies or decorate gingerbread houses
- ☐ Play board games or holiday trivia nights
- ☐ Make homemade ornaments or crafts

💡 *Put on Christmas music while crafting or baking — instant festive mood!*

Outdoor Adventures

- ☐ Go ice skating, sledding, or hiking
- ☐ Visit a tree farm or light display
- ☐ Have a snowball fight or build a snowman
- ☐ End with cocoa or a bonfire

💡 *Take candid photos — these make great next-year card moments!*

Activities for Kids

- ☐ Make Christmas wish lists together
- ☐ Read a holiday story each night
- ☐ Write letters to Santa or make gratitude notes
- ☐ Set up a holiday scavenger hunt

💡 *Encourage gratitude lists alongside wish lists, balance joy with mindfulness*

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Home and Guests



Prepare Your Home

- ☐ Declutter common areas before decorating
- ☐ Deep clean bathrooms, guest rooms, and kitchen
- ☐ Check linens, towels, and extra bedding
- ☐ Stock up on essentials (toilet paper, soap, tissues)

💡 *Only focus on rooms guests will see, small touches make big impressions.*

Guest Room Readiness

- ☐ Freshen up bedding and fluff pillows
- ☐ Add a welcome basket (snacks, toiletries, water bottles)
- ☐ Provide extra blankets and a phone charger
- ☐ Add festive touches like candles or greenery

💡 *A handwritten note or mini ornament on the bed adds instant warmth.*

Hosting Essentials

- ☐ Prepare an easy menu for arrival day
- ☐ Stock beverages and snacks for all ages
- ☐ Keep quick breakfast items handy
- ☐ Set up a cozy space for conversation or games

💡 *Don't over-plan — relaxed hosts make guests feel most welcome.*

Guest Comfort & Etiquette

- ☐ Offer clear Wi-Fi info and house rules
- ☐ Provide storage or a closet area for their belongings
- ☐ Ask about allergies, dietary needs, or routines
- ☐ Prepare small gifts or thank-you favors for guests

💡 *Hospitality is about thoughtfulness, little details make them feel at home.*

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Christmas Eve and Day



Christmas Eve Preparation

- ❑ Wrap final gifts and label them clearly
- ❑ Prep Christmas breakfast and dinner ingredients
- ❑ Charge devices for photos and videos
- ❑ Lay out outfits and pajamas for everyone
- ❑ Set out cookies, milk, and carrots for Santa & reindeer

💡 *End the night peacefully; light a candle, play soft music, and reflect on what you're grateful for.*

Setting the Scene

- ❑ Arrange gifts neatly under the tree
- ❑ Set the dining table or breakfast nook
- ❑ Turn on tree lights and holiday candles
- ❑ Prepare background music or a holiday movie lineup

💡 *Take one "quiet house" photo before bed — it captures the magic.*

Christmas Morning

- ❑ Brew coffee, cocoa, or tea before gift opening 🍵
- ❑ Capture photos and videos of the joy
- ❑ Have trash bags ready for wrapping paper cleanup
- ❑ Prepare breakfast or brunch ahead of time
- ❑ Give thanks before diving into the day

💡 *Pause before unwrapping — take a few deep breaths and truly be present.*

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Christmas Eve and Day Continued



Christmas Dinner & Celebration

- ☐ Confirm meal plan and serving order
- ☐ Warm dishes gradually, keeping sides covered
- ☐ Play light background music and dim lighting for ambiance
- ☐ Toast to loved ones — near and far
- ☐ End the evening with gratitude or a family tradition

💡 *Invite everyone to share their favorite memory of the season.*

Wind Down & Reflection

- ☐ Journal about the highlights of the holiday
- ☐ Write thank-you notes or reminders to send later
- ☐ Put leftovers away and tidy the main areas
- ☐ Take quiet time for yourself before bed
- ☐ Note what worked well for next year

💡 *A peaceful end helps your heart stay full long after the lights go out.*

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Celebrate Surviving Another Year

Take a Breath

- ❑ Look around — the wrapping paper tornado has passed.
- ❑ The dishes can wait. The memories can't.
- ❑ Sit down with your favorite drink and exhale.
- ❑ Remember: you showed up, loved hard, and made magic happen.

💡 *Perfection isn't the goal — presence is.*

Reflect & Release

- ❑ List three things that went beautifully this season
- ❑ Note one thing you'll do differently next year
- ❑ Forgive yourself for the things that didn't go as planned
- ❑ Release stress, expectations, and leftover to-do lists

💡 *Even the best traditions started messy — yours are still growing too.*

Celebrate Yourself

- ❑ You managed the chaos, kept the spirit alive, and made it through another year.
- ❑ Whether you did it joyfully, tearfully, or somewhere in between — you did it.
- ❑ Light a candle, pour a drink, or wrap up in your coziest blanket.
- ❑ Toast to your resilience, your growth, and your heart.

Looking Ahead

- ❑ Set one gentle intention for the new year — not a resolution, a kindness.
- ❑ Keep a short note of gratitude for this season.
- ❑ Dream about what peace and joy could look like next year.

💡 *A fresh year begins not with goals, but with grace.*

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